relief to his mind or body would give him renewed strength to deal with sustained interrogations. Instead, he had to be kept ‘tense’.

The Madras unit of the IB had intercepted a fresh message between the ‘rogue station’ in Madras and Jaffna, where the ‘sender’ was again asking for a boat. The sender had said he could not bomb the SIT without a boat waiting to sail him out of India. The security situation had changed after the assassination. Time was running out for him. Anirudhya’s friend in the IB was rushing to Malligai with the latest intercepted message. Security in Malligai had been tightened following the IB’s earlier intercept highlighting the LTTE’s threat to the SIT. But this second message underlined the LTTE’s threat and indicated that the sender had come from Jaffna and was looking for a quick escape route. After interpreting the new message, Kaarthikeyan decided to expand his network once again by inviting the public to look for the assassins.

Wall posters carrying photographs of Sivarasan, Nalini and Subha, along with a computer-generated image of Murugan, were plastered all over Tamil Nadu and thousands of prints were sent across India seeking information on them from the public. The hunt for Nalini and Murugan had been mounted. What Bhagyanathan had revealed about his sister was more like a backgrounder. A graduate in English literature from Ethiraj College in Madras, Nalini was the eldest of the three children born to Padmavathi and P. Sankara Narayanan. Neither Bhagyanathan nor Nalini had had a happy childhood due to marital issues between their nurse mother and police sub-inspector father. The couple had split when Nalini was fifteen. Nalini, too, had left home to live with a relative. She had had no political links until Bhagyanathan started interacting with the LTTE and brought home Murugan.[6] Bhagyanathan, however, refused to confirm his mother’s statement claiming that Nalini had escaped with Murugan. He maintained that she often fought with her mother and had hence left home. Last he knew, she had taken a room in a women’s hostel. Ragothaman asked